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Laurustinus (laurestinus)

1.13 Laurustinus (laurestinus)

References:

Hebrew תִּדְהָר (tidhar) [ISA 41:19](#), [ISA 60:13](#)

Discussion:



The identification of the Hebrew word *tidhar* in [ISA 41:19](#) and [ISA 60:13](#) is controversial. RSV and JB both use “plane” in these verses, the only places where the word *tidhar* occurs. Other versions have “fir” (CEV, NIV, NLT, REB, GW), “box” (NJPSV), and “pine” (KJV, supported by Moldenke). Zohary’s identification of *tidhar* as the *Laurustinus Viburnum tinus* is based on the Aramaic translation, *Targum Jonathan*, which translates *tidhar* as *mornian*, a cognate with *murran*, which is the Arabic name for *laurustinus*. Hepper agrees with Zohary. FFB (following Moldenke) cautiously identifies *tidhar* as the Brutian (or Turkish) Pine *Pinus brutia*. BDB and some others follow the Vulgate in translating this as “elm,” noting that the Syriac name for the common elm is “dadar.” The most recent evidence supports the *laurustinus*. The alternative spelling “*laurestinus*” is less common.

Description:

The laurustinus is a sturdy evergreen shrub that reaches 3.5 meters (12 feet) in height, with dark green, shiny leaves, white flowers, and poisonous purple berries.

Translation:

The laurustinus belongs to a family of trees that live in temperate and warm climates, including Europe, Asia, and North America, but close relatives of laurustinus are found only in the Mediterranean area. Since “laurustinus” is not a well-known name, and rather bulky for transliteration, it is perhaps better to transliterate from a major version or from Hebrew *tidhar* or Arabic *murrān*. However, the treatment of *tidhar* may depend on what the translator has done with the other words for trees in [ISA 41:19](#) and [ISA 60:13](#). If *berosh* is translated or transliterated as “fir,” then a different word (for example, “plane,” following RSV and JB) should be used for *tidhar*. In a study Bible “laurustinus” could be cited as a probable identity of *tidhar*, although “pine” runs a close second.